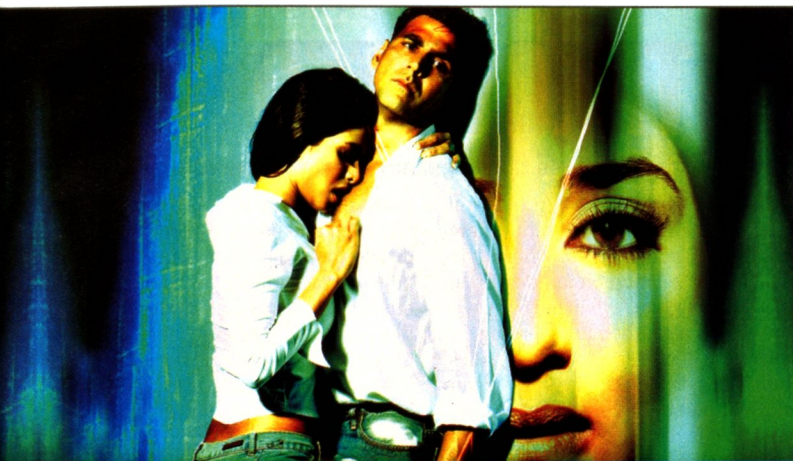




Salman Khan-Aishwarya Rai

Total Box Office impact:

●●● **Rs 27 cr**

Films: *Hum Dil De Chuke Sanam* (1999), *Dhaai Akshar Prem Ke* (2000)—special appearance

LOVE LOST: The two were known to be having an affair. After their separation, they never came together on-screen as the differences were too great for mending. Bhansali wanted to cast them together, but couldn't do so.



Hrithik Roshan-Kareena Kapoor

Total Box Office impact:

●●● **Rs 57 cr**

Films: *Mujhse Dosti Karoge* (2003), *Main Prem Ki Deewani Hoon* (2002), *Kabhi Khushi Kabhie Gham* (2001), *Yaadein* (2001)

LOVE LOST: Again, rumours of a romance took a toll on the hit pair. Zoya Akhtar tried to cast them in *Luck by Chance* but the film never took off. She tried to bring the two together once again, in *Kismat Talkies*, but in vain. Kapoor is no longer part of the film, while Roshan is.

Source: IBOSnetwork.com



tive films, they haven't faced the camera together since *Mujhse Dosti Karoge* in 2003. There have been numerous reports of Zoya Akhtar trying to bring the two together for her film *Luck by Chance*, which eventually never took off. She tried again, this time in the form of *Kismat Talkies* but casting seemed to have hit a roadblock here, too. In a recent interview to a tabloid Kapoor said she was no longer part of the film while Roshan is. When contacted, Akhtar maintained a firm "no comments" stand.

Though actresses might be dropping out of films, some filmmakers also outrightly admit that actresses don't really matter to a film. "It's a sad but well-known fact that it is a male dominated industry," says Manmohan Shetty, managing director, Adlabs Films. So, as a last ditch effort, when an actress shows her displeasure to work with an actor, she is usually the one 'replaced'. Or else, the film is shelved or delayed till the desired cast comes through. Sunil Manchanda, the owner of MAD Films, says, "It's a problem every producer faces. But they will never talk about star differences. And, if you do, your project runs into trouble. If a producer or director is facing problems he keeps his mouth shut." He adds that producers may have scrapped certain films because they didn't want to compromise on their actors. "I, for one, would scrap the project rather than take someone else," he says.

In the industry, a pair is often as good as its last hit and when the two have multiple hits to their credit they are virtually a gold mine. Akshay Kumar and Priyanka Chopra worked magic in *Andaaz*, *Aitraaz*, *Waqt* and *Mujhse Shaadi Karogi*, but as reports of their great on-screen chemistry and brewing romance started making headlines, the two suddenly couldn't find films to do together. There were reports that Priyadarshan wanted to cast the two for his film *Bhul Bhulaiya*, but took on Vidya Balan instead. However, the film's producer and T-series owner Bhushan Kumar says, "Priyanka was never even considered for the project." According to filmmaker Vipul Shah, who cast the two in *Waqt*, there is no problem between them. "They are just waiting for the perfect script." The wait for the audience might never be over. ■